

[Bubble Notifications](#)

The Case for Notifications

Without Notifications: The Silent Death of Engagement

Apps without notifications rely entirely on users remembering to open them — and they don't. Studies show that apps without push notifications see 20-30% lower retention after 90 days compared to those that use them thoughtfully. For a community app like Bubble, this is fatal. A member RSVPs to a Tuesday pickleball game, forgets about it, no-shows, and the organizer is left with an empty court. The organizer loses trust in the platform, stops hosting events, and the Bubble dies quietly. Without notifications, your app becomes a todo item users forget to check, not a living community they're part of.

With Notifications: The Pulse of Community

Notifications transform Bubble from a passive directory into an active community heartbeat. When a member gets "Bay Area Hikers: New event Saturday!" they feel pulled back into the group. When an admin sees "3 people just RSVPed" they feel momentum building. The 24-hour and 1-hour event reminders dramatically reduce no-shows — the single biggest trust-killer in real-world community apps. Meetup.com's data shows that reminder notifications reduce no-show rates by up to 40%. For Bubble, where "showing up" is literally a core value, notifications are the difference between digital interest and real-world attendance.

The Balance: Respect Earns Trust

The risk isn't notifications — it's bad notifications. Apps that over-notify get muted or deleted. Bubble's approach of reserving push for time-sensitive and action-required moments (event changes, reminders, join requests) while keeping informational updates in-app only respects user attention. This earns the right to stay un-muted. When a Bubble notification appears, users should think "this matters" not "not again." That trust compounds: users who keep notifications on have 88% higher engagement than those who mute them. Notifications aren't just a feature — they're the connective tissue between digital discovery and real-world presence.

Push Notification Costs

Short answer: Minimal cost to us, free to users.

Who	Cost
Users	Free (uses their data/wifi)

Bubble (us)	Nearly free — see below
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Our Cost Breakdown

Service	Cost
Apple APNs	Free
Google FCM	Free
Expo Push Notifications	Free up to 1,000 concurrent users, then minimal
Our server	Tiny compute cost to send —

Bottom line: At Alpha/Beta scale, push notifications cost us essentially \$0. At 100K+ users, maybe \$50-100/month

Bubble Notifications

Trigger	Who Gets Notified	Notification Text
Bubble created (pending approval)	Creator	"Your Bubble is pending approval"
Bubble approved	Creator	"Your Bubble has been approved!"
Bubble rejected	Creator	"Your Bubble was not approved"
New member joins	Admins	"[Name] joined [Bubble]"
Join request (private bubble)	Admins	"[Name] wants to join [Bubble]"
Join request approved	Member	"You're now a member of [Bubble]"
Join request denied	Member	"Your request to join [Bubble] was declined"
Member leaves	Admins	"[Name] left [Bubble]"
Member removed	Member	"You've been removed from [Bubble]"
New admin added	New Admin	"You're now an admin of [Bubble]"
Bubble edited (major changes)	Members	"[Bubble] has been updated"

Event Notifications

Trigger	Who Gets Notified	Notification Text
Event created	Bubble members	"New event in [Bubble]: [Event Name]"
Event edited (time/ location change)	RSVPed members	"[Event Name] has been updated"
Event cancelled	RSVPed members	"[Event Name] has been cancelled"
Member RSVPs	Admins	"[Name] is going to [Event Name]"
Member un-RSVPs	Admins	"[Name] can't make it to [Event Name]"
Event reminder (24 hrs before)	RSVPed members	"[Event Name] is tomorrow!"
Event reminder (1 hr before)	RSVPed members	"[Event Name] starts in 1 hour"
Event full	Admins	"[Event Name] is now full"
Spot opens (waitlist)	Next on waitlist	"A spot opened for [Event Name]"

Admin/Moderation Notifications

Trigger	Who Gets Notified	Notification Text
New report (concern)	Admins	"New concern reported in [Bubble]"
New report (Bubble-level)	Superadmins	"[Bubble] has been reported"
Report resolved	Reporter	"Your report has been reviewed"

What NOT to Notify

Action	Why Skip
Every Bubble edit	Too noisy — only notify on major changes (time, location)
Every chat message	Use chat badges, not bell notifications
Member views event	Creepy, unnecessary

Admin views member list	Internal action, no need
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Notification Priority

Priority	Types
 High	Event cancelled, removed from Bubble, report received
 Medium	Event reminders, RSVP updates, join requests
 Low	New events, member joins/leaves

Summary Counts

Role	Approximate Notification Types
Member	~10 types
Admin	~15 types
Superadmin	~3 additional types

Notification Delivery Matrix

Trigger	In-App Bell	Push	Why
Bubble Notifications			
Bubble pending approval			Not urgent, creator will check
Bubble approved			Exciting, time to invite people
Bubble rejected			Important, needs attention
New member joins			Nice to know, not urgent
Join request (private)			Requires admin action
Join request approved			Member wants to know
Join request denied			Closure needed
Member leaves			Informational only
Member removed			Important for that member

New admin added	✓	✓	Role change, important
Bubble edited (major)	✓	✗	Can catch up later
Event Notifications			
Event created	✓	✓	Drives engagement
Event edited (time/location)	✓	✓	Critical — plans may change
Event cancelled	✓	✓	Urgent — don't show up to
Member RSVPs	✓	✗	Noise for admins if pushed
Member un-RSVPs	✓	✗	Noise for admins if pushed
Event reminder (24 hrs)	✓	✓	Helpful, expected
Event reminder (1 hr)	✓	✓	Last chance reminder
Event full	✓	✗	Informational for admins
Spot opens (waitlist)	✓	✓	Time-sensitive, compete for spot
Moderation Notifications			
New report (concern)	✓	✓	Needs timely review
New report (Bubble-level)	✓	✓	Superadmin needs to act
Report resolved	✓	✗	Not urgent, check when convenient

Summary

Type	In-App Only	In-App + Push
Informational	✓	✗
Action required	✓	✓
Time-sensitive	✓	✓
Exciting/positive news	✓	✓

Push Notification Principles

Principle	Application
Respect attention	Don't push unless it matters
Time-sensitive = push	Event changes, reminders,
Action required = push	Join requests, reports
Informational = in-app only	Member joins, RSVPs, edits
Let users control	Future: notification preferences in settings

Future: User Notification Preferences

Setting	Options
Event reminders	24 hrs / 1 hr / Both / None
New events in my Bubbles	Push / In-app only / Off
Admin notifications	Push / In-app only